

Alpha testing

It is the operational testing of a game, tested by potential users/customers or an independent test team at the developer's site. For this, professional testers are hired; bugs are checked, features to be added are listed. This phase makes the game ready for Beta Testing.

Beta testing

It is an external user-acceptance testing. Versions of software known as beta versions are released to a limited audience outside of the team. This testing is conducted to get a feed-back of the players. It has to be kept in mind that Beta Testing can be conducted only when the game contains no bugs. Beta Testing means all the known bugs have been corrected and there is no system or feature to be added in the game.

III. Post-Production

Once the game is complete, it enters the post-production phase. This phase includes extensive testing, review, publishing, marketing and finally, distribution.

Testing and review

Testers play your game repeatedly in continuation to play testing done during production phase. The major and minor bug fixes done during production phase are fixed and a beta version of the game is released (often open to public). This beta version is excessively tested and reviewed until in-house team of developers, testers etc are satisfied and even the public beta receives a good feedback.

Obtaining ESRB rating

Parallel to the testing, a copy of the game is sent to Entertainment Software Rating Board (ESRB) to be reviewed and a rating is given to the game based on its content.

Master gold-release

This is the final version of the game which is ready for printing and publishing. In this phase, the incremental portions of the game are frozen. Hence, no more code, art or design to be added.

Publishing

Games like movies need publishers. For independent game developers,